

world and are, instead, located almost completely in the Near Dreaming. Homesteads are generally run by commoners, but are almost always beholden to another freehold for trade and defense. Homesteads may be specific, focusing on only a single resource, or generalized, producing a wider variety of goods.

Workshop

Workshops are freeholds with an almost completely physical presence, and only a footprint in the Dreaming. They may be owned by nobles, but almost all of them are staffed and run by commoners (usually nockers or boggans). Workshops are where chimerical steel is forged, voile sewn, and ale brewed. Glamour is rarely harvested for personal use, but is instead used in the creation of Treasures and other faerie goods.

Other Sacred Spaces

- ⑤ **Lost One Freeholds** — During the Shattering, some fae chose not to return to Arcadia or stay in the mundane world. Instead, they barricaded themselves inside their freeholds and remained isolated during the Evanescence. The Resurgence brought back these lost lands, but the long centuries have had their impact: these freeholds are chaotic and strange, powerful but wild, and can trigger Bedlam in unwary changelings who enter them.
- ⑤ **Nunnehi Freeholds** — European fae frequently misunderstand the nature of Nunnehi freeholds, which are sacred spaces more spiritual than chimerical, intimately shaped by the cultural dreams of whichever tribe cares for them. The Nunnehi Nation and their lodges are covered in detail in Appendix I (p. 392).

Freehold Creation

On the cusp of Winter, creating a freehold is no simple task. Making a freehold from scratch often requires several heroic quests to locate resources and gather components. While it is the most difficult method of acquiring a freehold, it is arguably the one with the richest rewards.

Locating a lost freehold may be a chapter in a chronicle, but creating one is an entire story unto itself. Many obstacles stand in the way of individuals seeking a new freehold. It is less daunting for an oathcircle to pool their resources to accomplish the task.

Step One: Wellspring

Wellsprings are places where the Dreaming leaks through, creating a bubble in the skin of the mundane. Free wellsprings are incredibly rare in the modern age; most have been claimed by other changelings, mages, or shapeshifters.

Wellsprings bubbling through in cities and towns typically pierce the boundaries of the Dreaming in locations that are rich in emotions, creativity, and dreams. The house next door to a best-selling fantasy author might prove fruitful, or the open-air stage in a public park.

Step Two: Rath

The would-be freeholder needs to pierce the skin of the world, using Wayfare ③③③ (Portal Passage) and Fae ⑤⑤⑤⑤⑤ (Dweomer of Glamour) to create a rath. Should she lack the requisite knowledge of Wayfare and Fae, she may alternately use a Treasure containing the same levels, or convince a sentient chimera with the Traverse Dreaming Rede to open it for her.

Step Three: Balefire

Creating a new balefire is a long, arduous process that involves gathering resonant Glamour from Dreamers whose dreams reflect the nature of the freehold the changeling wishes to build, or collecting dross from chimera in the area she wishes to build. She then invests them gradually into a mundane fire. Once she has fed the flames with enough Glamour (seven times the intended level of the freehold), the Glamour catches alight. If the fire dies before the final steps, she must start fresh with a new fire and new Dreamers.

Alternately, she may hand carry a torch burning with the flames of another balefire to ignite her own. While this seems easier and faster on the surface, taking seed fire from a freehold is fraught with its own complications, most notably that it weakens the parent balefire by one rank until the new freehold is complete. Most freeholders are wary at best and hostile at worst to such requests, but may offer it as a favor or reward (and, of course, changelings can attempt to steal it).

Step Four: Glamour

The simplest step is also the one changelings have the most trouble accomplishing: the investing of personal Glamour into the balefire. Despite lip service to the sanctity of freeholds and the need for more sacred spaces, many changelings are reluctant to weaken themselves permanently in order to create more freeholds.

Alternate methods of investing Glamour can lessen the impact creating a freehold has on an individual:

- ⑤ Oathcircles or motleys may share the burden, each contributing 1 or more dots of Glamour until the intended rank is achieved.
- ⑤ The freeholder may sacrifice chimerical companions to the flames. Though the practice has largely fallen out of use, it recalls ancient rituals of sacrificial fertility magic. A willing chimera lowers the cost of invested Glamour by (its rating + 1), with no ill effects for the freeholder. To determine the chimera's rating, see Chimera, p. 315. An unwilling chimera sacrificed lowers the cost of invested Glamour by (its rating - 1).
- ⑤ The freeholder may destroy one or more Treasures (⑤ - ⑤⑤⑤⑤) to mitigate the personal cost. This garners Banality (see p. 269) and is the riskiest method, because it triggers an immediate stability roll, with a pool equal to the freehold's rating at a difficulty of the changeling's permanent Banality. Success lowers the investment cost by the Treasure's rating. If this roll fails, the wellspring becomes unusable for a year